

Run-scoring breakdown in Tests since 2022

Team	% from 1s	% from 2s	% from 3s	% from 4s	% from 5s	% from 6s
Afghanistan	31.57	13.71	4.09	40.74	0.21	4.09
Australia	28.53	12.03	5.11	43.29	0.06	4.56
Bangladesh	29.68	12.75	2.78	43.81	0.15	5.06
England	27.29	12.92	3.71	44.37	0.05	6.89
India	30.44	9.97	2.87	41.41	0.21	9.91
Ireland	26.22	11.23	4.25	47.03	0.30	5.14
New Zealand	28.13	11.85	4.37	42.41	0.08	7.90
Pakistan	30.65	13.52	5.34	40.01	0.04	5.61
South Africa	28.38	12.72	4.65	42.82	0.10	5.69
Sri Lanka	31.15	11.64	4.28	43.01	0.12	5.88
West Indies	25.97	14.47	5.89	41.59	0.23	6.42
Zimbabwe	27.50	14.39	5.30	42.97	0.00	5.25

nation. The average across all teams for this period is only 6.03 per cent. India has smashed 37 sixes so far against England – the most by any side on a tour away from home.

Correspondingly, in recent years, the team has relied very little on finding pockets of space in the outfield to keep the scoreboard ticking. Only 9.97 per cent of India's runs over the last three years have come from running twos – comfortably the lowest among any international team in whites.

Boundaries weren't the primary source of runs for India when it began its journey in Test cricket. In its first-ever Test match – against England in 1932 – India scored just one boundary: a six by Amar Singh, who also made the country's first Test fifty.

Larger boundaries, smaller bats and a general reluctance to play aerial strokes can all be cited as reasons for this.

In its first three decades (1930 to 1959), 80.89 per cent of India's Test

runs came from running between the wickets – second only to Pakistan (82.19%).

England and Australia, with their head start in the sport, were more efficient in their run-scoring during that era. While the English scored 28.52 per cent of their runs through boundaries, for the Australians it was as high as 30.66 per cent.

With time and experience, Indian batters began to adapt. The share of runs from running declined with each passing decade, finally dipping

India's run-scoring means in Test cricket over the decades

■ % from 4s ■ % from 6s ■ % Running ■ % Extras

